KCC CODE CLUB · GAME MAKERS

Week 8 Lesson Plan

Polish, Test and Showcase

Big idea: Finishing is a skill. Making something work for *someone else* is different from making it work for you.

This class is structurally different from the other seven. It's one long working session that ends with every game finished, shared and backed up. The showcase itself doesn't fit in a sixty-minute class, so it's its own event with families in the room — ideally straight after this class or at the next KCC gathering. Read the Showcase Run Sheet alongside this plan.

At a glance

New concepts	Debugging strategy, user experience, sharing and remixing, online citizenship
New blocks	None. This week is consolidation
Class activity	Find the Bug, then Playtest Swap
Project checkpoint	Finished, shared, demo-ready
Homework	None. A "keep going" sheet instead

Before the class

- Print the Week 8 handout and the certificates.
- A deliberately broken Scratch project ready on the projector for Find the Bug. Break it yourself the night before: remove a `wait` from a `forever`, point a `touching?` at the wrong sprite, and leave out a `set score to 0`. Three bugs, increasing subtlety.
- The club **Scratch studio** created and ready for students to add projects to.
- A USB stick for the `.sb3` backups, which feed the showcase fallback.
- Certificates printed and **names filled in** before the showcase — the night before, not on the day.

0:00–0:05 — Show & Tell

Last one. Take two, and pick children who haven't presented yet all term — some will have been quietly waiting for permission all course. Everyone gets their turn at the showcase anyway.

0:05–0:13 — Find the Bug (whole class)

Put the broken project on the projector. Don't tell them how many bugs there are.

Run it. Ask: *"What did you expect, and what did it do?"* Take suggestions from the floor and try them — including wrong ones. Getting it wrong publicly and recovering is the demonstration.

As you go, name the three strategies on the board:

1. **Say what you expected and what happened.** Half of all bugs are found in this sentence.

2. **Change one thing at a time.** If you change three things and it works, you don't know why.
3. **Explain it out loud to someone.** Even to a rubber duck. You'll usually find it mid-sentence.

Eight minutes, three bugs, done. If the third one is taking too long, give it to them. This is the most transferable thing in the entire course — it applies to homework, to arguments, and to the rest of their lives.

0:13–0:25 — Playtest Swap

Everyone stands up and moves two seats to the right. You now play the game in front of you for five minutes, **without asking its author anything**.

On the card provided (on the back of the handout):

- Two things you liked
- One thing that confused you
- One thing you'd add

Then move back and read your card.

The rule that makes this work: **the author may not defend their game.** They just read the card and say thank you. Watching a child discover that their instructions made perfect sense to them and no sense to anyone else is the entire lesson about user experience, and it needs no explanation from you.

0:25–0:50 — Polish sprint

Fix what the playtest turned up, then work down the finishing checklist. Put it on the board:

1. **Title screen** — the game's name and the author's name
2. **Instructions** — one line, on the title screen. "Use the arrow keys to catch the mangoes."
3. **Score and lives visible** and readable
4. **Game over screen** showing the final score
5. **At least one sound**
6. **Credits** — their name, and the club

Be ruthless about scope. If a child wants to add a boss fight in the last twenty minutes, the answer is no — write it on their "keep going" sheet for next week instead. A polished simple game demos far better than an ambitious broken one, and there is no recovering from a game that breaks in front of forty parents.

Sharing

Walk them through **See Project Page → Share**, then adding the project to the club studio.

Take two minutes for the online citizenship conversation, properly:

- Anyone in the world can see a shared project. Don't put your full name, your school, your address, or a photo of yourself in it.
- Comments are public. Be kind. If someone is unkind to you, don't argue — report it and tell an adult.
- If you use someone else's sprite, sound or idea, credit them. That's what the credits screen is for. Remixing is encouraged on Scratch; pretending it's all yours isn't.

0:50–1:00 — Back up and get ready to present

- Everyone saves, shares, and checks the project is in the club studio.
- **Copy every student's project to the USB stick as an `.sb3` file.** This is the showcase fallback. Wi-fi at community venues fails at exactly the wrong moment, and with the files on a stick and Scratch Desktop on the presenting laptop, the showcase carries on and nobody knows.
- Each student writes their two showcase sentences on the handout: what the game is, and the hardest bug they fixed. That last one is the good question. It turns a demo into a story.
- Tell them, and their parents at pickup, when and where the showcase is.

The Showcase — its own event

Full detail in the Showcase Run Sheet. With fifteen students it runs about fifty minutes, which is why it can't share a slot with this class. Structure:

- Two minutes of welcome from a volunteer. Keep it short — the parents are here for their kids.
- Each student demos for **two minutes**: what the game is, a quick play, and the hardest bug they fixed.
- Certificates.
- Ten minutes of open play where parents try the games and the kids explain them. This is the best part and it happens by itself.

No homework

Instead, everyone leaves with the **keep going** sheet: where to find more projects, how to keep building, and what next term looks like.

Point them at:

- More Scratch — the natural next step
- Further Scratch — clones, My Blocks, boolean logic
- Code Club Aotearoa projects — free, local, hundreds of them
- The club studio, so they can see what everyone else built and remix it

Five project ideas for the holidays

On the keep-going sheet:

1. A two-player version of Sky Catcher — one on the arrow keys, one on WASD.
2. A quiz about something you love, with a score.
3. An animated version of a story you know.
4. A drawing app using the Pen extension.
5. A "guess the number" game where the computer picks and you guess.

Notes for the second volunteer

In class, your job is the USB backup: every project, on the stick, before anyone goes home. At the showcase it's logistics — certificates, chairs, and making sure every single child gets their two minutes. Watch for the

quiet one who says they don't want to present — offer to stand next to them and ask the questions, which almost always works. Nobody should leave without having shown their family something they made.

Afterwards

- Message every parent within two days with the studio link, so they can show grandparents.
- Ask two questions in that message: what did your child like most, and would they come back? You'll want the answers when you plan term two.
- Write down what went wrong while you still remember it. You will run this again, and week-one you will thank week-eight you.